FARSHORE

The Odyssey: Arcade Trials

Phase 2: Interface structure and AI interaction design



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CMPS 4200 HCI / October 8, 2026

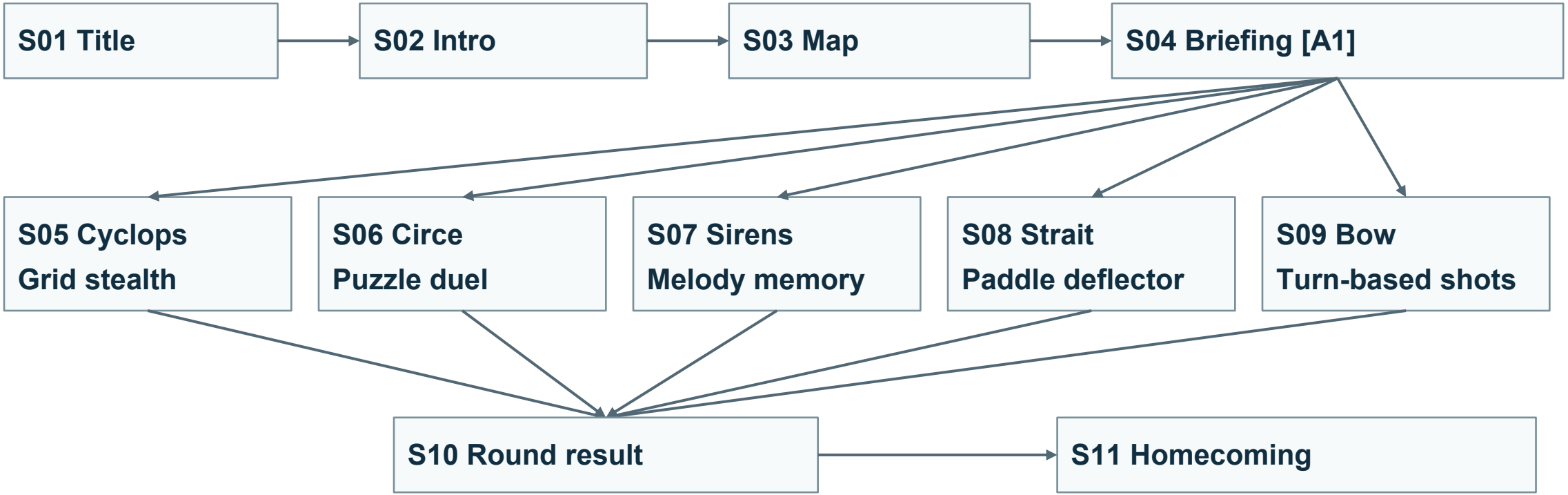
The five arcade trials

Each shore uses different controls and shows an active rival

Shore	Player interaction	Visible rival action
Cyclops	Grid stealth	Blind smash from noise clues
Circe	Falling-potion match-3	Own board, chains and curses
Sirens	Four-lane melody memory	Composes and targets missed lanes
Scylla & Charybdis	Shield paddle and rowing	Six heads with pulsing vortex
Ithaca	Turn-based archery	Own scored shot or ring block

Screen hierarchy

A1 in the briefing is the only model feature in arcade mode

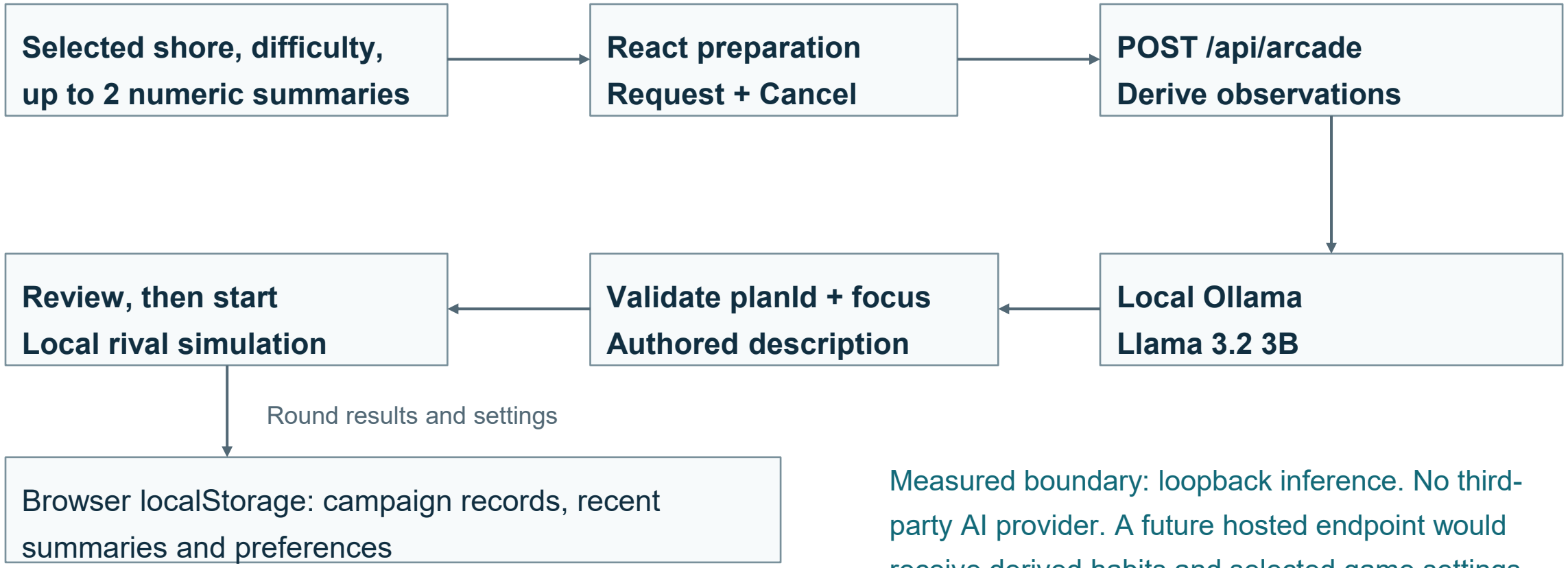


Next trial opens its briefing after a clear or assist. The fifth passage opens Homecoming.

Shared overlays: S12 Settings, S13 Pause/leave, S14 Restart, S15 Assisted passage

Model data flow and privacy

One of two allowed strategies. Local game logic plays the round.



Measured boundary: loopback inference. No third-party AI provider. A future hosted endpoint would receive derived habits and selected game settings.

Player task flows

Five persona-linked paths. Full steps and branches are in the design packet.



Pause preserves the round. Practice awards no clear. Assistance has its own label.

AI preparation states

Five low-fidelity states keep progress and player choice visible

Initial

Difficulty and mode
Local rival available
Prepare with model

Loading

Preparing strategy
Elapsed time and Cancel
Gameplay clock stopped

Success

Strategy and fixed rules
Start / Prepare another
Edit difficulty or mode

Uncertain

Unsupported strategy
No match has started
Retry / local AI / Solo

Error

Service unavailable
Voyage progress kept
Retry / check / local play

AI technical spike

Six synthetic use-case inputs, real local Llama 3.2 3B calls

Min 7.317s Mean 8.279s Max 11.613s

Sample	Seconds	Selected plan	Review
S1 First-time Cyclops	11.613	focused/center	Legal, advisory mismatch
S2 Circe after two losses	7.597	chain/balanced	Matches loss preference
S3 Sirens with red-lane misses	7.317	echo/balanced	Legal, lane targeting is local
S4 Strait after one hull loss	7.889	pincer/balanced	Legal, advisory mismatch
S5 Archery after low ring score	7.614	feint/balanced	Legal block-shot policy
S6 Cyclops with left-side habit	7.641	focused/left	Schema fixes left focus

Six legal outputs from one sequential run. Tactical quality still needs evaluation.

Recovery and next steps

Two real provider failures and one application validation failure

Triggered condition	Observed response	Designed recovery
Nonexistent model	Provider HTTP 404	Check / retry / local play
Malformed provider JSON	Provider HTTP 400	Explain / keep selections
Unsupported difficulty	App HTTP 400	Supported-choice guidance

Implemented

Elapsed time, Cancel and plan validation.

Local saves, practice and assistance.

Proposed or awaiting evidence

Discard and provider privacy detail.

Interviews, peer critique and fairness tests.

No live 429 or capacity test. Hardware and future hosting costs are unmeasured.